

like American Airlines, FedEx, UPS, Delta and Avis Budget Group, among others, have opened centres between 2019 and 2024. “Over 55% of the travel and transportation GCCs have been set up in the last seven years, driven by the success of incumbents, mature operating models and accelerated speed-to-value,” the Talent 500 report said, adding India is home to more than 35 travel and transportation-related GCCs, employing over 45,000 professionals.

Andrea Zimmerman, SVP and President, of Target in India says, “The mix of retail, technology and talent in India has gigantic potential to shape global retailing and commerce. GCCs also have the opportunity to further enable a consistent and seamless guest (consumer) experience that is powered by technology across all channels, particularly with the emergence of the phygital guest.”

KEY CHALLENGES

Despite a vast talent pool, the high demand for skilled professionals leads to increased attrition rates. Enterprises would have to invest in strong retention strategies, employee engagement programs and career growth opportunities. A recent CIEL HR study highlights rising talent pressures.

With 52% of GCC professionals actively job-hunting and 51% of organisations citing talent retention as their top challenge in 2025, the sector is facing high attrition, evolving employee expectations and intense competition for niche digital skills.

In addition to this, as GCCs scale up in ambition and complexity, new risks are beginning to emerge.

► **INDIA HOSTS MORE THAN 50% OF ALL GCCs WORLDWIDE**

► **GCCs NOW LEAD AI, PRODUCT DESIGN, R&D AND BOARDROOM DECISIONS AND DON'T JUST PROVIDE BACKEND SUPPORT**

► **BFSI, HEALTHCARE AND RETAIL DOMINATE THE FAST-GROWING GCC EMPLOYMENT LANDSCAPE**

► **TIER II AND II CITIES HOUSED ABOUT 7% GCCs IN FY24, UP FROM 5% IN FY19**

► **SMALLER CITIES LIKE MADURAI AND GANDHINAGAR ATTRACT GCCs DUE TO TALENT, CONNECTIVITY AND COST ADVANTAGES**

► **INDIA'S TALENT POOL AND SUPPORTIVE POLICY FRAMEWORK MAKE IT RESILIENT AND FUTURE-READY**

Global regulatory challenges are one of the few growing threats. Evolving data protection laws, digital sovereignty requirements and cross-border compliance complexities could limit the services that GCCs can deliver from India. Geopolitical shifts and rewiring of digital supply chains will further demand operational agility, espe-

cially as nations adopt more protectionist policies or restructure digital infrastructure.

An EY survey conducted last year found that among the key tax and regulatory concerns for GCCs, transfer pricing was a notable challenge. When asked about their expectations for supporting growth and expansion, 75% of GCCs highlighted the need for simplified compliance processes, 65% sought tax benefits and incentives and 60% emphasised the importance of enhanced infrastructure. Talent development programmes and stronger data privacy and security regulations were also seen as important priorities.

The survey also found that the risk of confidential information leaks due to increasing cyberattacks and data breaches is a top concern for GCCs. With prolonged hybrid and remote work expanding the attack surface, security intelligence and monitoring are a priority for 73% of GCCs. Additionally, 82% of GCCs believe it is crucial to enhance cybersecurity awareness among employees while implementing robust cybersecurity policies and procedures.

GCCs are transforming from cost-effective back offices to innovation hubs, but to sustain this pace to its full potential, India will need to close its widening skills gap, especially among fresh graduates. Aligning academic courses with industry needs and investing in lifelong learning will be the key to inclusive and future-proof growth. **BT**

(With inputs from Neetu Chandra Sharma)

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